never felt that I belonged to a minority community. I do not know why I did it.'[16]

Neeta Sharma begins her story thus:

> The Delhi Police on Thursday allowed four people held in connection with the attack on Parliament to go public with their version of how it was planned and how terrorists operate.
>
> The Jaish-e-Mohammad's chief co-ordinator in India, Mohammad Afzal, was unrepentant, saying that had he not been caught he would have worked to inflict another strike against India.
>
> His accomplices—Shaukat Hussain, Afsan and Syed Abdul Rahman Geelani—were not taking the cue. They claimed that Afzal had drawn them into the dragnet.
>
> If the US and Pakistan want more evidence of the involvement of Pakistan-based groups in terrorism in India, Afzal's disclosures should give them leads.
>
> Among the many disclosures made by the Jaish militant was the claim that the ISI has been funding terrorists from across the border and has set up many bases in the POK to train militants.[17]

Neeta Sharma begins with a lie. Geelani was not allowed to address the press conference—he was not even brought into the room. In addition to this front-page story on 21 December 2001, the *Hindustan Times* carried a story by Swati Chaturvedi, entitled 'Terror Suspect Frequent Visitor to Pak Mission'. This time the journalist quotes 'authoritative sources' who have told her that Geelani visited the Pakistan High Commission. The High Commission itself is quoted as saying: 'As far as we are concerned we do not know him and Pakistan has nothing to do with him.' The report goes on to state (without so much as an 'alleges'):

> During interrogation, Gilani has admitted that he had made frequent calls to Pakistan and was in touch with militants belonging to the Jaish-e-Mohammad. He also said he was in touch with relatives in London who were actively involved in funding militancy in Jammu and Kashmir.
>
> Gilani said that he had been provided with funds by some members of the Jaish and told to buy two flats that could be used in militant operations.[18]

The media conference by the Special Cell was designed to help the government in power to prove its case about Pakistan's involvement in the Parliament attack. They needed to do it quickly and could not wait for the trial. In any case when the trial did start it did not go into the actual attack itself.

But that media conference was to serve one other purpose. That was to get Afzal to implicate Geelani. *Aaj Tak* chief reporter Shams Tahir Khan was also present at the media conference. He asked a pointed question of Afzal: '*Aap ka jo sathi hai Geelani uske paas Osama bin Laden ka kucch literature bhi milaa hai. To kya woh Laden ko maanta hai?*'